

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Prevent and Protect | Hybrid Infrastructure and Azure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience implementing and managing security controls across hybrid on-premises and cloud environments, including Microsoft Azure and Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory). I have extensive hands-on experience across the prevent and protect pillars of cyber security, including Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), vulnerability management, identity and access security, and security monitoring. My technical expertise spans CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, enabling me to implement security controls and improve security posture across complex hybrid estates. I have led the deployment of enterprise security platforms at scale, managing security across an environment of over 8,000 users, and have proven capability in strengthening security controls, reducing attack surface, and driving measurable risk reduction. I am well-suited to a fully remote senior engineering position within a growing cyber function where I can contribute immediately to implementing robust prevent and protect security controls across a hybrid infrastructure and Azure environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Prevent:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); large-scale deployment and policy management
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), detection engineering, alert triage, automation
- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Microsoft 365 security controls
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS), risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Security Monitoring and Threat Hunting:** Proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK, IOC identification, behavioural analytics
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, structured incident lifecycle management, root cause analysis, post-incident reporting
- **Device and Endpoint Security:** Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM, endpoint compliance policy enforcement, CrowdStrike Falcon agent management
- **Email and Gateway Security:** Mimecast, anti-phishing and anti-spam policy management, DLP controls
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony, IDS/IPS, network segmentation principles
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation workflow development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 -- Present*

- Lead the implementation and ongoing management of security controls across a hybrid on-premises and Azure cloud environment for an organisation of over 8,000 users, working within the prevent and protect function of the cyber security team.

- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Prevent, Insight, Discover) across all endpoints, implementing prevention policies and proactively hunting for threats using behavioural analytics and IOC searches.
- Administer Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, authoring and tuning KQL detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, managing alert triage, and building SOAR automation playbooks to accelerate incident response.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, configuring alerts, policies and automated response actions to strengthen endpoint and identity security.
- Administer Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, SSO and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to secure identity across the hybrid estate.
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS), driving remediation activities and tracking risk reduction metrics for senior leadership.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM policies, maintaining device compliance baselines and enforcing application security controls across managed and bring-your-own device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Lead security incident response in accordance with NIST SP 800-61, coordinating with IT infrastructure teams and serving as the senior escalation point for complex or high-impact security incidents.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes, improving user resilience against social engineering and reducing organisational risk.
- Contribute to continuous security improvement by assessing the effectiveness of existing controls, identifying gaps, and implementing enhancements aligned to CIS Controls, NIST CSF, and Cyber Essentials Plus.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

- Implemented and managed CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent and Insight across the enterprise estate, improving endpoint visibility and threat prevention capabilities at scale.
- Managed security controls in Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender, creating detection rules and responding to incidents across the hybrid Azure and on-premises environment.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) Conditional Access, MFA and SSO policies, strengthening identity security and enforcing least-privilege access for over 8,000 users.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting across CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying attacker behaviours and indicators of compromise (IOCs) mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Managed vulnerability scanning and remediation using Tenable.io, working with infrastructure and application owners to address identified weaknesses and reduce the organisation's attack surface.
- Supported Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM policy management, ensuring device compliance and secure access for remote and mobile users.
- Contributed to phishing simulation exercises and security awareness initiatives, improving staff awareness of cyber threats and reducing risk of successful social engineering attacks.
- Produced regular vulnerability and incident management metrics and reports to support governance obligations and security improvement planning.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) -- IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 -- March 2022

- Delivered security engineering across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, implementing security controls including access management, endpoint protection and security monitoring.
- Administered identity and access management including MFA, SSO and directory services, ensuring compliance with the principle of least privilege.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation of weaknesses across the internal technology estate, supporting the organisation's risk reduction objectives.
- Supported firewall and network security policy management, contributing to the reduction of the attack surface across the company's hybrid infrastructure.

- Managed device compliance using MDM tooling to ensure all endpoints met security baselines prior to network access.
- Contributed to ISO 27001-aligned security quality processes including risk assessments, security policy reviews and documentation maintenance.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across over 8,000 users at UAL, achieving comprehensive endpoint visibility and enabling proactive threat prevention across the hybrid infrastructure.
- Implemented Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform for UAL's Azure environment, engineering detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK that improved alert fidelity and reduced analyst workload.
- Deployed Pentera Breach Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate the effectiveness of security controls, identifying and remediating critical attack paths across the hybrid estate.
- Rolled out BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls, eliminating standing privileged access for over 200 administrative accounts and strengthening the organisation's identity security posture.
- Delivered SOAR automation workflows using CrowdStrike and Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to security incidents by approximately 40%.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating that security controls across UAL's hybrid infrastructure met UK government baseline security standards.
- Implemented Conditional Access policies in Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) across 8,000 users, enforcing risk-based access controls and significantly reducing identity-related attack risk.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 85,000 - 100,000 | Remote (UK)